🔎 Plant ID: Reading

Horticulture 1 · Unit 4 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with Plant ID template, 16 bedding plants, Plant ID quizzes and final

Name: _____

Identifying Bedding Plants

Bedding plants are young flowering plants grown in greenhouses and sold in spring for gardens, pots and hanging baskets. Being able to identify them is one of the most important skills for a greenhouse or garden center worker, because customers ask what a plant is and how to care for it.

To identify a plant, start with its flower type: simple, tube or composite. Marigolds (Tagetes), gerbera daisies and African daisies (Osteospermum) have composite flowers. Snapdragons (Antirrhinum), fuchsias and lobelia have tube flowers. Petunias, geraniums (Pelargonium), stock (Matthiola) and begonias have simple flowers.

Next, look at the leaves and the growth habit. Upright plants such as snapdragons and stock grow tall. Mounding plants such as sweet alyssum (Lobularia maritima) and begonias form a dome. Trailing plants such as Wave petunias, calibrachoa, bacopa, lobelia and lysimachia spill over the edge of pots. Sweet potato vine (Ipomoea batatas) is grown for its colorful leaves rather than its flowers.

The class Plant ID template has 15 fields: common and scientific name, life cycle, growth habit, height, leaf form, margin and arrangement, flower type, water and light needs, uses, selling points, colors and two photos. Selling points, such as 'blooms all summer' or 'great for baskets,' help customers choose at the plant sale.

Check your reading

1. Name two plants with composite flowers and two with tube flowers.

2. Which plants would you choose for a hanging basket and why?

3. Why are selling points included on a Plant ID card?